

# Childhood & Early Genius

- Born in Potsdam, Germany, February 9 1925, his Father was a high ranking Bank official.
- Raised in a warm family environment; early exposure to astronomy through Bruno Bürgel's book *Aus fernen Welten*.
- At age 6, memorized constellations; by 8, taught himself 1,000+ Chinese characters to write in secret code. But also had to start school
- Early fascination with chemistry, physics, and explosives.
- At 10, received a chemistry set and began building explosives.
- Attended Victoria-Gymnasium in Potsdam from 1935 but bored with standard school curricula.
- By 11, manufactured TNT and built rockets; conducted launch across frozen Templiner lake with a explosive charge on the tip of a rocket with 12 years.



Heim with his Grandfather



Joel Michalowicz